unchanged for some time. Showing me both the orders, he had asked me for my choice, but in all fairness, never tried to cancel either of them. I had said then that I would go wherever he felt was best, and that's how I had landed up in Fatehgarh in 1987. My elder daughter Isha was born during that tenure and I had the pleasure of seeing her growing up, along with sleepless nights and changing nappies. I had gone for the Junior Command course from Fatehgarh, an important career course and secured an instructional 'I' grading, which not only changed my career profile but paved the way for my clearing the DSSC entrance exam a few years later. So, who was I to argue with Gen Kapur? 2 RR it was then.

The Rashtriya Rifles was a force created in 1990 specifically to deal with counter-insurgency/counterterrorist (CI/CT) operations and was the brainchild of the then COAS. 2 RR was among the first of the Battalions to be raised, on 1 October 1990. The organizational structure of the RR was still quite fluid but stabilizing. Each Battalion had four Companies worth of troops from the primary arm, one of the Infantry Regiments and two Companies worth from a secondary arm—armour, artillery, engineers, etc. The supporting elements were also drawn from respective support services—ASC, EME AMC, etc. Thus, an RR Battalion was like a microcosm of the Army. All the existing units of the Army sent their personnel to their affiliated RR units as per the vacancies allotted. 2 RR was a combination of the SIKH LI and Bombay Sappers. Over time, the RR had become an outlet where units could send their problem cases, those with attitude or disciplinary records. I, too, had been guilty of getting rid of some of my recalcitrant jawans from 7 SIKH LI to the RR. Imagine my surprise and chagrin, when I was confronted by some of those very same boys when I reported to 2 RR. They had a glint in their eyes which seemed to convey, that I too,

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